This week's 5 AI-chip breakthroughs, in plain English

Oct 28, 2026. Light-powered chips, memory tricks, and why glass is the new gold. Which companies around the world could win or lose?

⏱️ **TL;DR: the 60-second version**

1. **The big idea:** AI's biggest problem isn't thinking fast. It's *moving data* fast enough, and this month's money and science went there.
2. **Closest to real money:** new ways to build chips with glass bases and "chip glue" (Applied Materials + Besi). Score 7/10.
3. **Most surprising:** startup Volantis already has 26 patent filings for moving memory using light.
4. **Smart move:** IBM posted a science paper and also filed a patent on the same idea, with the same team.
5. **India:** CG Power and Kaynes run chip-packaging plants that are already producing.

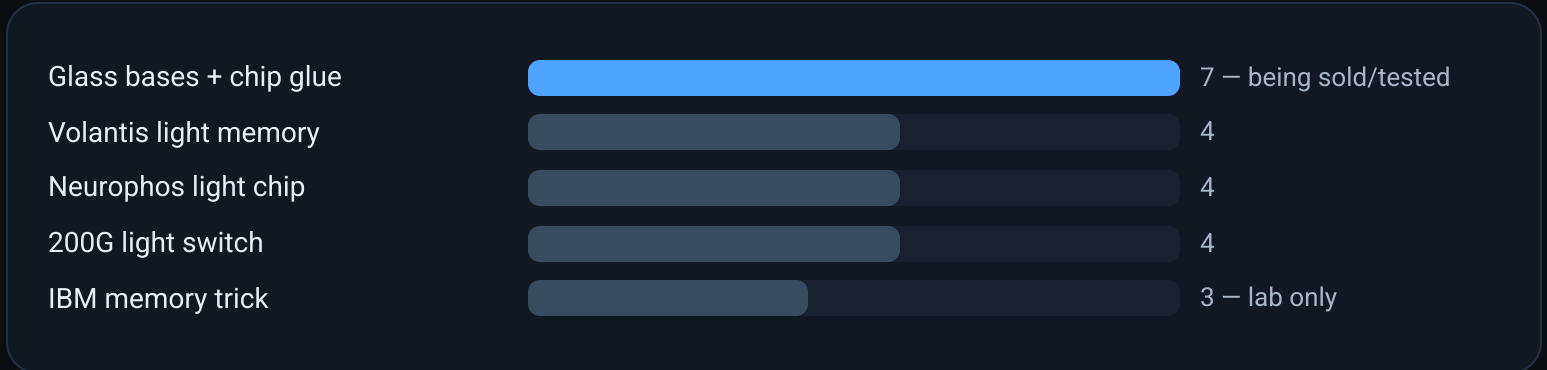
Scores are our judgment. Not investment advice.

💡 **Did you know?** A modern AI chip package can hold several chips plus stacks of memory, and it gets so big and hot that today's plastic-like bases can warp. That's why glass is in the news.

Ready-o-meter

How close is each idea to a real product? 1 = lab dream, 10 = on store shelves.

Our estimate



1. Neurophos: a computer chip that thinks with light

What if your AI chip did its math with *light* instead of electricity?

🧠 **Think of it like this:** Today's chips are like a crowded highway of tiny cars (electrons) that heat up the road. Neurophos wants to swap the cars for flashlight beams, which are faster, cooler and can cross each other without crashing.

WHAT IT IS

A startup building an "optical" chip (photonics) for AI math. MIT researchers are now testing it on real problems (Oct 21).

WHY YOU SHOULD CARE

Electricity bills are the biggest cost of running AI. The company says its approach could use about 50x less (its own claim, not tested yet).

WHAT TO WATCH

First real systems are planned for 2028. Watch for big chipmakers partnering with it.

Ready-o-meter: 4/10 (our judgment)

▼ The proof (facts and sources)

Patents (checked)	US 11,120,332 B2 (2021), US 11,843,182 B2 (2023), WO 2021/026152 A1, EP 4007888. Owner: Neurophos. First filed 2019.
Size claim	Its light switches are about 10,000x smaller than older designs, with millions on a 5x5 mm chip (company claim).
Stock	Neurophos is private. GlobalFoundries (GFS) is linked only through a conference talk.
Source type	University news plus patent records.

2. Volantis: moving memory at the speed of light

Can a startup with 26 patent filings break AI's biggest traffic jam?

🧠 **Think of it like this:** An AI chip is like a genius chef with a tiny pantry far away. Every ingredient trip wastes time. Volantis wants to build a light-speed conveyor belt straight from a giant pantry to the stove.

WHAT IT IS

A startup building a light-based interposer that links huge memory to AI chips.

WHY YOU SHOULD CARE

AI chips often sit idle waiting for data (the "memory wall"). Fixing that could change who sells memory, like today's HBM.

WHAT TO WATCH

A first working product is about 12–18 months away, according to reports. Watch for funding news and new patent grants.

Ready-o-meter: 4/10 (our judgment)

▼ The proof (facts and sources)

Claims	Up to 10 TB of memory at up to 240 TB/s per chip package (The Register, Oct 5). Earlier, the company claimed 1 pJ/bit links. These are company claims.
Patents (checked)	26 published US applications and 3 grants (latest Aug 25, 2026). For example US 2026/0119385 A1, US 2026/0121756 A1, US 2026/0219465 A1.
Stock	Private. No listed partner named.
Source type	Press interview, checked against patent records. No peer-reviewed paper found.

3. IBM: storing many things in one memory spot

What if one parking space could hold several cars at once, and you could still drive each one out?

🧠 **Think of it like this:** Normally each memory cell holds one item, like one book per shelf slot. IBM layered several items into the same slots, like overlapping see-through pages, and could still read each one back.

WHAT IT IS

A new IBM trick, posted on arXiv (2610.26118), that stacks many pieces of AI data into one memory chip and does the math right where the data lives.

WHY YOU SHOULD CARE

More AI memory without more chips could mean cheaper, smaller AI hardware.

WHAT TO WATCH

It's a lab prototype with no product plan yet. Watch whether IBM uses it in its own AI chips.

Ready-o-meter: 3/10 (our judgment)

▼ The proof (facts and sources)

Result	Tested on a real prototype chip, using data from shopping-recommendation and chatbot AI models. Accuracy was about as good as normal software.
Patents (checked)	US 2026/0291719 A1 (published Sep 24, 2026), owned by IBM, with the same team as the paper. Earlier related patent: US 10,678,885 B2 (IBM).
Stock	IBM (IBM). Related research by Micron (MU) staff: arXiv 2610.20359.
Source type	Science preprint plus patent application.

4. The light switch that sends 200 billion bits a second

How do you send 200 billion bits a second through something thinner than a hair?

🧠 **Think of it like this:** Think of a traffic light that blinks so fast it can send a whole movie in a blink, while using about as much energy as a tiny static spark.

WHAT IT IS

A tiny silicon part (320 µm, about 3 hairs wide) that turns electric signals into light signals, from a study in Nature Communications (Oct 22).

WHY YOU SHOULD CARE

It sends data faster using less power and fewer extra chips. That helps put light links inside chip packages (co-packaged optics).

WHAT TO WATCH

It's still a lab device. Watch for chip companies licensing it.

Ready-o-meter: 4/10 (our judgment)

▼ The proof (facts and sources)

Result	140 Gb/s at 26 femtojoules per bit (a tiny amount of energy); 200 Gb/s with extra signal clean-up.
Patents	None from this research group were checked this week. Check before relying on it.
Who	The paper names no company selling it.
Source type	Peer-reviewed science journal.

5. Glass and 'chip glue': the breakthrough closest to your wallet

Why are the world's biggest chipmakers suddenly obsessed with glass?

🧠 **Think of it like this:** Today's chip bases are like plywood: they bend when hot and heavy. Glass is like granite, flat and steady, so you can build a bigger 'house' of chips on top. Hybrid bonding is like welding Lego bricks together so tightly there's no gap at all.

WHAT IT IS

Two upgrades to how chips are put together: glass bases instead of plastic ones, and hybrid bonding.

WHY YOU SHOULD CARE

This is already being sold and tested by customers, so it is the most likely of this week's five to show up in company earnings soon.

WHAT TO WATCH

Applied Materials and Besi tool orders, and Samsung Electro-Mechanics' glass line (target end-2027).

Ready-o-meter: 7/10 (our judgment)

▼ The proof (facts and sources)

Facts	Applied Materials and Besi expanded their partnership (Oct 1). Their joint 'Kinex' machine is on sale. Samsung Electro-Mechanics' glass bases are being tested in real chip packages. BOE's 24-layer glass bases are in AI-chip trials.
Patents (checked)	US 12,550,662 B2 (granted Feb 10, 2026) and US 12,538,855 (Jan 27, 2026), both owned by Applied Materials.
Stocks	AMAT (Nasdaq), BESI (Euronext Amsterdam). Samsung Electro-Mechanics and BOE are listed in Korea and China (tickers not checked).
Source type	Company news, product page, patent grants.

💡 **Did you know?** A patent is public. Anyone can read what a company is planning, often years before it shows up in a product. That's one of the 'radar signals' we look for.

🌍 Around the world: who's involved

Taller bar = more listed companies we tracked in that region this week.



Region	Company	Stock code	Topic	What we found
USA	Applied Materials	AMAT, Nasdaq	Chip gluing (#5)	Kinex die-to-wafer bonder co-developed with Besi; Oct 1 expansion
Taiwan	TSMC	2330.TW	Glass chip bases (#5)	Validating glass-core substrates for CoWoS with Ibiden and Innolux (Chosunbiz, Jun 2026)
Taiwan	ASE	3711.TW	Chip packaging (#5)	Largest chip packager (OSAT), 1H26 revenue $7.56B, +33.1%; TGV glass pilot line targeted Q3 2026
South Korea	SK hynix	000660.KS	Chip gluing (#5)	Reported first mass-production hybrid-bonding order using AMAT and Besi tools; full-scale use expected around HBM5
South Korea	Samsung Electronics	005930.KS	Chip gluing (#5)	Evaluating Besi hybrid bonders; says partial use from HBM4E
Japan	Ibiden	4062, TSE	Glass chip bases (#5)	Co-developing glass cores with TSMC; says it holds 70–80% share of AI-server substrates
Japan	Advantest	6857.T	Chip testing (#1, #4)	Record Q2 FY26 (Oct 28); cites strong silicon-photonics and chiplet test demand
Japan	Tokyo Electron	8035.T	Chip-making machines	CFO sees a record ¥1tn operating profit on AI demand (Nikkei, Oct 7)
Europe	Besi	BESI, Euronext Amsterdam	Chip gluing (#5)	Joins Applied's EPIC Center; under evaluation at Samsung
Europe	STMicroelectronics	STM, NYSE	Light links (#4)	PIC100 in high-volume production for hyperscalers; capacity to quadruple by 2027; TSV version targets co-packaged optics
Europe	ASML	ASML	Chip printing machines	Its earnings were cited by Bernstein as showing AI-driven demand strength
China	JCET	600584, SSE	Glass bases and light links (#4, #5)	Pilot lines for glass substrates and panel-level packaging; CPO capability; AI data-center revenue +54% (9M26)

Region	Company	Stock code	Topic	What we found
China	SMIC	0981.HK	Chip maker and packaging	Expanding advanced packaging for AI chips; raising some advanced-node prices
India	CG Power / Kaynes	NSE: CGPOWER / KAYNES	Chip packaging (#5)	See India angle below

Stock codes come from market.vlsi.kr, company sites or press releases. Some companies were left out because we couldn't confirm their link or stock code.

🟢🔴 Who could win, who could lose

Our judgment from the facts. ++ = big plus, + = plus, − = could be hurt, +/− = mixed, – = no clear effect.

Company	Light-based computing	Compute-in-memory	Glass chip bases	Chip gluing (bonding)	Light links in chips	Why (fact or our judgment)
Applied Materials	–	–	+	++	+	Fact: Kinex bonder, granted bonding patents, CPO in EPIC scope
Besi	–	–	+	++	+	Fact: co-develops Kinex; under evaluation at Samsung
Advantest	+	–	–	–	++	Fact: says demand is strong for testing light-based chips and chiplets
TSMC	–	–	++	+	–	Fact: validating glass for CoWoS. Judgment: bonding helps 3D stacking
ASE	–	–	+	–	–	Fact: glass trial line; packaging revenue +33%
STMicroelectronics	-	–	–	–	++	Fact: makes light-based chips in volume. Judgment: light built straight into the chip package (like Volantis) could skip its plug-in parts
JCET	–	–	+	+	+	Fact: glass pilot lines, CPO capability, AI revenue +54%
Ibiden	–	–	+/-	–	–	Fact: co-develops glass with TSMC. Judgment: glass could erode its organic-substrate lead
SK hynix	–	-	–	+	–	Fact: first bonding order. Judgment: light-linked memory and compute-in-memory

Company	Light-based computing	Compute-in-memory	Glass chip bases	Chip gluing (bonding)	Light links in chips	Why (fact or our judgment)
						could hurt demand for its stacked AI memory (HBM) long term
Samsung Electronics	–	-	–	+	–	Same as SK hynix (judgment)
Tokyo Electron	–	–	–	+	–	Fact: record profit outlook on AI. Judgment: benefits from more process steps
SMIC	–	–	–	+	–	Fact: expanding advanced packaging
CG Power / Kaynes	–	–	-	–	–	Fact: packages chips the older way (wire-bond). Judgment: far from glass and bonding, so they could fall behind
Today's AI chip leaders (GPU makers, unnamed)	-	-	–	–	–	Judgment: Neurophos targets about 50x efficiency vs GPUs (company claim, systems planned 2028)

Winners and losers by company

🟢 Green = could benefit from these discoveries. 🔴 Red = could lose business. Longer bar = bigger effect.

Our judgment, −5 to +5, as of Oct 28, 2026



Winners and losers by region

The USA looks set to gain most this week. South Korea's memory makers face some risk.

Our judgment: average of the company scores



🇮🇳 The India angle

Only companies with a link we could confirm in a source

Company	Stock code	What they do	Source
CG Power and Industrial Solutions	NSE: CGPOWER	CG Semi chip-packaging plant in Sanand, ₹7,584 cr, with Renesas and Stars; producing since mid-2026	pib.gov.in; DSCI report
Kaynes Technology India	NSE: KAYNES	Kaynes Semicon chip-packaging plant, ₹3,307 cr; producing since Mar 31, 2026	pib.gov.in; genvest.ai
SPEL Semiconductor	Listed, small company	Older-style chip assembly and testing	genvest.ai
Tata Electronics	Not listed	Assam packaging plant (₹27,120 cr) and Dholera chip factory with PSMC, both being built	pib.gov.in; DSCI
3D Glass Solutions (Odisha)	Not listed	Approved glass-base packaging project	tensor-advisory.com

> **Careful: look-alikes.** Owning Tata Technologies or Tata Elxsi stock does *not* mean you own Tata Electronics' chip plants. One research firm (Equirus) rates CGPOWER and KAYNES "Reduce" (Business Standard). No Indian listed company was linked to light-based computing or compute-in-memory.

📅 What happened where, and when

Region	What happened	When	Why it matters
USA	Neurophos + MIT light computing; Volantis light-memory plan	Oct 21 / Oct 5	Light-based chips leaving the lab
Japan	Advantest record quarter; Tokyo Electron results due	Oct 28 / Oct 30	A clue to how strong AI chip demand is
Japan	200G light switch study	Oct 22	Cheaper, cooler data links
South Korea	Glass chip bases being tested	Oct 6	Glass line targeted for end-2027
China	JCET AI revenue +54%; BOE glass trials	Oct 22 / Oct 16	China building its own advanced chip packaging
Europe	Besi joins Applied's research center	Oct 1	Chip glue becoming an industry standard
India	CG Semi and Kaynes plants producing	2026	India's new chip-packaging base

📜 Who owns the ideas (patents)

For information only, not legal advice

Pick	Key patents	Owner	What it tells us
Neurophos	US 11,120,332; US 11,843,182; EP 4007888	Neurophos	Got in early (2019). The worldwide filing has lapsed, so check which countries are covered
Volantis	26 US applications, 3 grants	Volantis Semiconductor	Filing fast in 2026, which could block copycats
IBM	US 2026/0291719 A1; US 10,678,885	IBM	Paper and patent from the same team, so IBM likely plans to use or license it
200G light switch	Not checked	—	Open question
Glass + chip glue	US 12,550,662; US 12,538,855	Applied Materials	Protects how the machines work. Besi is a partner but not a co-owner of these

Who should read this?

Reader	What you get	Try this week
Startup investor	Spot startups from patents, early	Look into Volantis' and Neurophos' patents
Trader	Technology linked to stock codes and timing	Watch AMAT and BESI for orders, and CGPOWER and KAYNES for factory growth
Company research team	Who already owns which ideas	Check the Neurophos and IBM patents before starting similar work
Everyday investor	Plain-English trends, with hype flagged	Learn to tell real chip companies from 'chip' look-alikes

📖 Quick word list

Tap or hover over any dotted word on this page to see what it means.

OSAT	a company that packages and tests chips for other companies
HBM	stacked, extra-fast memory that sits next to AI chips
photonics	using light instead of electricity to move or process information
patent	a legal claim saying 'we invented this, others need permission to copy it'
hybrid bonding	joining chips straight together, copper to copper, with no solder bumps
substrate	the base board a chip sits on inside its package
interposer	a thin bridge layer that connects several chips side by side
co-packaged optics	putting light-based data links right inside the chip package
arXiv	a free website where scientists post papers before formal review
readiness score	our 1–10 guess at how close an idea is to a real product
ticker	the short code used to find a stock, like AMAT

🔭 Next week on FrontierRadar

Can a computer run on **light alone**? Will glass really replace plastic inside every AI chip? Next week we follow the money into the next wave, and check which of this week's 5 signals moved.

Teaser only. Topics may change based on what the science shows.

📬 Don't miss the next storm

Get the top 5 discoveries every week, free. Plain English, 5 minutes to read, with no hype.

Placeholder: no data is collected yet.

Plans

Plan	Price	What you get
Free	$0	Top 5 headlines and scores every week
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Teardown	$299/mo	Pro plus a monthly deep-dive with slides
Enterprise	From $2k/mo	Custom watchlists, patent alerts, calls with analysts

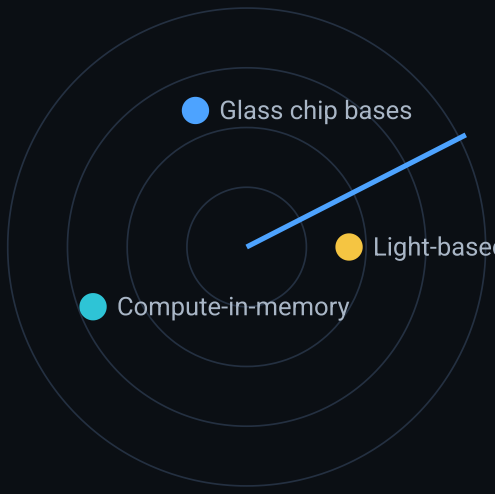
Not investment advice. This is research to help you learn, not a tip to buy or sell. Scores are our judgment. Do your own homework before you invest.

Sources

1. Julia Lab and Neurophos collaboration
2. US11843182B2, Neurophos
3. WO2021026152A1, Neurophos
4. Patents assigned to Neurophos LLC (US 11,120,332)
5. Volantis photonic interposer plan (The Register)
6. Volantis Semiconductor assignee profile
7. Superposed analog memory for vector storage (arXiv 2610.26118)
8. IBM US 2026/0291719 A1 (Patentlyze)
9. IBM US 10,678,885 B2
10. Weight splitting on noisy in-memory accelerators (Micron, arXiv 2610.20359)
11. 200G/λ slow-light silicon modulator (Nature Communications)
12. Applied Materials and Besi expand partnership
13. US20240170443A1 / US 12,550,662
14. US 12,538,855 (USPTO Official Gazette)
15. Kinex hybrid bonding system
16. Samsung Electro-Mechanics glass substrates (MoneyToday)
17. BOE 24-layer glass substrates (DIGITIMES)
18. Approved semiconductor projects (PIB India)
19. OSAT stocks in India 2026 (Genvest)
20. CG Power and Kaynes listed exposure (Business Standard)
21. TSMC glass substrate validation with Ibiden (Chosunbiz)
22. Ibiden 1Q FY2027 earnings call (Envalith)
23. Ibiden interim Q&A
24. Samsung and SK hynix hybrid bonder timing (Chosunbiz)
25. SK hynix hybrid bonding at Hot Chips 2026 (Tom's Hardware)
26. Advantest Q2 FY2026 results
27. Advantest earnings call (Investing.com)
28. Tokyo Electron record profit outlook (Nikkei Asia)
29. Bernstein on Japanese chip stocks (Investing.com)
30. ST PIC100 silicon photonics in high-volume production
31. JCET Q3 YTD 2026 results
32. China advanced packaging and OSAT ranking (eefocus)
33. SMIC returns to advanced packaging (DIGITIMES)
34. Glass core substrate sector research (ASE pilot line)
35. Chip company ticker list (market.vlsi.kr)
36. State of India's Semiconductor Industry 2026 (DSCI)
37. India semiconductor project map (Tensor Advisory)

Patent info is for learning, not legal advice. Scores are our judgment. Performance numbers are what the companies claim. Patent databases can be slightly out of date.

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FrontierRadar

See the breakthrough before the market does.

A weather radar for technology: new science in, simple scores out.

A weather radar spots a storm before it hits your town. FrontierRadar spots **technology storms** before they hit the news or stock prices: a new science paper, a wave of patents, a factory starting up.

⏱️ **The 60-second version**

1. We read the newest science and patents every week, so you don't have to.
2. We give each idea a simple score: how close is it to a real product? (1 = lab dream, 10 = on sale)
3. We show which companies could win 🟢 or lose 🔴, in the USA, India and around the world.

💡 **Did you know?** Inside an AI data center, moving data between chips can use more power than the math itself. That is why so many of this week's discoveries are about moving data faster, not thinking faster.

How it works, in 5 steps



How a reader might use it

1. **Spot the trend:** In our sample report, glass chip bases and chip "gluing" scored 7/10, the highest of the week.
2. **See who's involved worldwide:** USA: AMAT. Taiwan: TSMC (2330.TW), ASE (3711.TW). Korea: SK hynix (000660.KS), Samsung (005930.KS). Japan: Ibiden (4062), Advantest (6857.T). Europe: Besi, STM. China: JCET (600584).
3. **Look at India:** CG Power and Kaynes both run chip-packaging plants (OSATs) that started producing in 2026.
4. **Know what to watch for:** big order announcements, factories growing, and Samsung Electro-Mechanics' glass line (planned for end-2027).
5. **Decide for yourself:** Do your own research, and use your own broker and your own risk rules.

> **Example only, not a recommendation.** One research firm (Equirus) rates CG Power and Kaynes "Reduce" (Business Standard). Not investment advice.

Plans

Prices are early guesses we're testing

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Play with the numbers. This is example math, not a forecast. Enterprise counted at $2,000/mo.

Free readers

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Money per month

$14,880

Money per year

$178,560

Free readers who pay

12.0%

Who is this for?

Reader	Their problem	What they get	Plan
Everyday investor (any country)	Too much hype; stocks with 'chip' in the name that don't make chips	Simple scores and real company links	Free / Pro
Active trader	Hears about trends after prices already moved	A stock list across 7 regions: US, Taiwan, Korea, Japan, Europe, China, India	Pro
India-based trader	Few Indian stocks really tied to chips	Checked links for CG Power and Kaynes, with look-alikes flagged	Pro
Startup investor	Finds hot startups when everyone else does	Startups spotted from patents, before they raise money	Teardown
Investment fund	Too many papers to read	A weekly scored summary with sources	Teardown / Enterprise
Company research team	Might miss who already owns an idea	Patent lists and possible licensing partners	Enterprise

🌍 We cover the whole world

Companies we tracked this week, per region

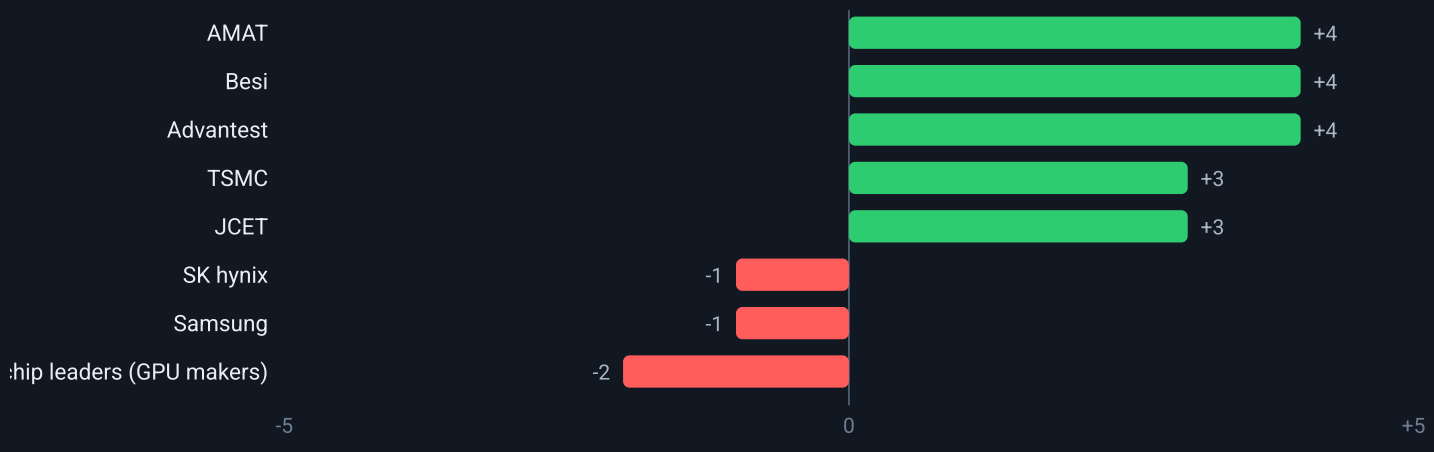
Japan	Ibiden, Advantest, TEL
Europe	Besi, STM, ASML
Taiwan	TSMC, ASE
South Korea	SK hynix, Samsung
China	JCET, SMIC
India	CG Power, Kaynes
USA	AMAT

Region	Watch this week
USA	Neurophos teams up with MIT on light-based computing; Volantis' light-linked memory
Japan	Advantest record quarter (Oct 28); Tokyo Electron results Oct 30
Korea	Glass chip bases being tested in real chip packages
China	JCET's AI revenue up 54%
Europe	Besi joins Applied Materials' research center
India	CG Semi and Kaynes chip-packaging plants producing

Who could win or lose?

🟢 Green bars could gain from this week's discoveries. 🔴 Red bars could get hurt.

Our judgment, from the sample report



How we're different

Service	What it does	Price	What we add
CB Insights	Tracks private companies, funding and deals	Not public; seat-based	We start from the science, not the deals
AlphaSense	AI search of business documents for pros	Quote-based; third-party data says about $12k/yr to start	Simple readiness scores at a lower price
Elicit	AI help for reading research papers	Plus $12/mo, Pro $49/mo (third-party listing)	We link science to patents, stocks and timing

One other competitor couldn't be checked, so we left it out.

Why it's hard to copy

Papers + patents together

Example: an IBM science paper matched to IBM's own patent filing

A simple score

1–10, with reasons, tracked every week

Truly global

7 regions, with fake 'chip stocks' flagged

One study, many formats

Email, slides, video and social posts

The first 90 days

Stage	Days	What we do	Goal
Prove it	1–30	4 weekly issues on AI chips, free email, social posts	200 free readers
Earn	31–60	Launch Pro at $49, first deep-dive, patent alerts	10 paying readers
Grow	61–90	Add a second topic (quantum or bio), 3 business trials, sponsor pack	First business customer

Risks vs opportunities

🟢 Green = chances to grow. 🔴 Red = things that could go wrong. Longer bar = bigger.

Our judgment, from −5 to +5. Not a forecast.



What could go wrong, and our fix

Risk	How we handle it
AI makes up a source	Every claim is linked, and a human checks each issue
People treat it as stock tips	Clear 'not advice' labels, no buy or sell calls
Costs too much to run	Weekly, one topic first
Big companies copy us	Speed, India depth, and a growing archive
Readers won't pay	Free plan first, sponsors in the meantime

How we'll know it's working

- Free readers and how many open each email (goal 40%+)
- Free readers who start paying (goal 2–5%)
- Monthly income, and how many people cancel
- Mistakes in sources (goal: zero per issue)
- Hit rate: how often our picks later show up in news or earnings
- ✔ Sample report #1 done (Oct 28, 2026)

📖 Quick word list

Tap or hover over any dotted word on this page to see what it means.

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Placeholder: no data is collected yet.

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Sources

- Sample weekly report: AI chips, Oct 28, 2026 (all company and patent sources)
- CB Insights pricing
- AlphaSense pricing
- AI market research tools (Elicit, AlphaSense pricing)

Not investment advice. Scores and win/lose ratings are our judgment. Patent notes are for learning, not legal advice. Performance numbers are what companies claim. © 2026 FrontierRadar.